

Chapter 156-5

After finishing the congee, Xu Qingzhu didn't go back to sleep. Instead, she took Ling Dang to the other room to play the piano.

Ling Dang also had piano lessons, but she didn't really like them.

After all, practicing piano was quite a tiring thing. But she liked watching others play, so she sat on the bed and had Xu Qingzhu play for her.

Smooth and beautiful melodies drifted out from the room, and Ling Dang, being a qualified audience member, immediately applauded.

The whole home became much livelier.

Ling Dang was like a little sparrow, chirping and chattering all around the house.

Xu Qingzhu only sat there for a while before feeling a bit stuffy, and her lower back was a bit sore.

So she went back to the bedroom to lie down.

Strangely, though, she hadn't bled much during this period.

She guessed it might just be the early stage of her period.

Zhao Xuning even sent a message asking when she would come to pick up the medicine, or if Zhao Xuning should deliver it to her.

Xu Qingzhu felt embarrassed to have her deliver the medicine, so she told her to hold onto it for now and that she'd have her secretary pick it up in the afternoon.

Ling Dang left in the evening. Since Xu Qingzhu wasn't feeling well, she indulged herself and stayed home for the day. During this time, she even answered a video call from Lu Jiayi, who called to discuss details about their collaboration.

They talked for an hour on video alone.

At that time, Liang Shi was sitting beside Xu Qingzhu, watching a drama on an iPad with the volume turned very low.

Ling Dang had commandeered their TV to watch "Erta the Rabbit."¹

This dark fairy tale-style animated series was long and had many episodes, but Ling Dang watched it with great interest.

After Lu Jiayi finished discussing the collaboration with Xu Qingzhu, she also asked about her health.

Having learned that Xu Qingzhu hadn't gone to work, Xu Qingzhu answered each question politely.

Listening from the side, Liang Shi didn't feel much.

If yesterday, seeing Lu Jiayi and Xu Qingzhu walking out of the company together like a match made in heaven had made her jealous—

Then today, hearing the two chat about their collaboration with such perfect rapport, she no longer felt that jealousy. It was more of a sigh: so the system's driving force was this powerful.

Indeed, when it came down to it, Lu Jiayi was the one who belonged to the same world as Xu Qingzhu.

Their conversation wasn't entirely about work. At one point when discussing a certain topic, the two went off on a tangent.

Xu Qingzhu recommended a book to Lu Jiayi—a very long English title that Liang Shi had never even heard of. Lu Jiayi's eyes lit up and she agreed: "Yes, that's exactly what I wanted to say! I really like the perspectives in it too."

At the time, Liang Shi even looked it up on her phone. It was a very obscure book.

Yet such an obscure and difficult book had been read by both Lu Jiayi and Xu Qingzhu, and they shared the same views on it.

This was probably not just the power of the original plot, but more like meeting a soulmate whose soul was perfectly matched.

Liang Shi listened until they finished talking.

After hanging up, Xu Qingzhu opened her laptop and started working. When she worked, she was extremely focused, able to shut out the entire world.

Liang Shi watched her from the side for a while, then got up to cook.

Ling Dang followed her like a little tail, turning off the TV and going into the kitchen with her, leaving the living room space to Xu Qingzhu.

She couldn't really say whether she was sad or not. It was as if in that moment, Liang Shi had resigned herself to fate.

She seemed to have fought hard, but things hadn't gone as she'd hoped.

Lu Jiayi was the one who was more suited to Xu Qingzhu.

But Liang Shi didn't show it. She still thoughtfully cooked for Xu Qingzhu, then at night helped warm her stomach and held her while they slept.

When Xu Qingzhu was startled awake by nightmares, she gently wiped the sweat from Xu Qingzhu's forehead, then kissed her lips, softly stroked her back, and comforted her that such things wouldn't happen.

Xu Qingzhu buried herself in the crook of her neck, leaving deep marks.

After the nightmare, lingering tears of fear also fell on her skin.

Liang Shi accepted it all calmly.

Footnotes:

1. "Terra the Rabbit" (兔子不哭): Literally "Rabbit Don't Cry" - appears to be a fictional dark fairy tale-style animated series mentioned in the story.